

Credible Insights Style Guide

How to write an article for `/insights` so it holds up for a marketer deciding whether to hire you, a search engine ranking it, and an answer engine citing it.

Applies to every article under `/insights`.

The one rule

An Insights article is an argument, not a summary.

If a reader finishes and can't say what Credible thinks, the piece has failed. Neutral explainers get outranked by whoever has more domain authority, and they give an answer engine nothing distinctive to cite. Take a position, then support it.

Practical test: could a competitor publish this article word for word without contradicting anything they believe? If yes, there's no argument in it.

The naming rule

Credible's positioning uses "creator". Search demand sits almost entirely on "influencer", "thought leadership" and "employee advocacy".

Both facts are true and neither changes. So:

- **Titles, H1s, meta descriptions and opening paragraphs** use the language people search
- **The body** makes the creator distinction the argument
- **Never** target a phrase with no search volume in a title, however much better it reads

This isn't a compromise, it's the piece. "Why the industry calls this influencer marketing and why that framing costs brands money" is a better article than either label alone.

Check volume before committing to a title. A phrase that sounds native to how Credible talks internally is often a phrase nobody outside the company types.

Structure

Every article follows the same shape.

- | | |
|---------------------------|-----------------|
| 1. H1 | the question or |
| claim, in search language | |
| 2. Standfirst | one or two |
| sentences, the position | |

3. Opening answer	40–60 words, self-contained
4. H2 sections	each opening with its own direct answer
5. Where to start / CTA	
6. FAQ	3–5 questions

H1

Question-shaped or claim-shaped, never a filing label.

-  Micro vs Macro Influencers: Does Reach or Relevance Win in B2B?
-  Executive Thought Leadership: Why Leaders Are Becoming the Channel
-  Micro vs. Macro B2B Creators
-  Thought Leadership Trends

Labels tell a reader what shelf the piece sits on.

Questions tell them what they'll know afterwards, and they match how people actually search and prompt.

One H1 per page. Never repeat it as the first H2.

Standfirst

One or two sentences stating the position, not the topic.

Chasing the biggest audience is a consumer marketing habit. It maps onto B2B badly, but not for the reason most people give.

Opening answer

The most important 60 words in the article. Answer the H1 directly, in a passage that makes complete sense lifted out of the page with no surrounding context.

Choosing a B2B influencer comes down to five checks: audience fit, content-market fit, engagement quality, how they've handled brand work before, and whether their working style matches your team's capacity. Follower count appears in none of them.

Then the context, the caveats and the reasoning. Never the other way round. A reader who stops after the first paragraph should still have the answer, and an answer engine lifting one passage should lift a correct one.

H2 sections

Every H2 gets the same treatment in miniature: direct answer first, reasoning second.

H2s should read as steps in an argument, not as topics. "Start with audience fit, not follower count" beats "Audience fit".

Never demote a section heading to H3 unless it's genuinely nested inside another section.

FAQ

Three to five questions, at the end, wrapped in FAQPage schema.

Use real questions people ask, phrased as they'd phrase them. Answer each in 40–70 words, completely, without requiring the article above it.

The FAQ isn't filler. It's often the most-cited block on the page, because each answer is already the right length and shape for extraction.

Depth

Floor is roughly 800 words. If the material won't support that, the topic is too thin to compete and should be a section of something bigger.

Depth means specificity, not padding. One worked example with real numbers beats three paragraphs of principle.

Sourcing

Every statistic gets a source, a year, and a link. No exceptions.

-  LinkedIn's 2026 B2B marketing research reports that 82% of B2B marketers say creators increase credibility with decision-makers [linked]
-  Some recent industry surveys put over 70% of B2B marketers expecting a significant increase in spend
-  Studies show that buyers trust peers more than brands

Unlinked statistics are the fastest way to lose both a sceptical marketer and an AI citation. If a figure can't be sourced, cut it. The argument is usually stronger without it.

Label illustrative examples as illustrative. A hypothetical presented as data is worse than no data.

Check the arithmetic in every worked example.

Numbers that contradict the argument they're supporting are the most damaging error available, because they're the part readers check.

Internal linking

Minimum for every article:

- **Up to its cluster pillar**, once, early
- **Out to at least one case study**, as evidence for a specific claim

- **Out to the roster**, where a creator type or archetype is described
- **Across to one sibling article**, where a point is expanded elsewhere

Case studies are the proof layer for everything argued in Insights. An article claiming relevance beats reach is an opinion. The same article linking to a five-creator campaign that segmented by relevance is evidence.

Never link on "click here" or "read more". Link on the claim.

Clusters

Every article belongs to one cluster and links to that cluster's pillar. The pillar links to every article in its cluster.

Two articles arguing the same thing with the same evidence will compete with each other. If a new piece overlaps an existing one, either narrow the new one sharply or fold it into the old one. Don't publish both and hope.

When a new article covers ground an existing one touches, remove that ground from the older piece and link out to the new one instead.

Tone

The audience is brand and agency marketers. Peers who've run campaigns and can tell when they're being sold to.

Do

- Take a position and defend it
- Concede the strongest counter-argument. It's the fastest way to earn trust and it usually makes the piece more interesting
- Use specifics: real numbers, real constraints, real tool names
- Use contractions
- Give the reader something to act on

Don't

- Use contrast framing. "The story wasn't X, it was Y". Just say what happened.
- Use suspense hooks: "here's what most brands get wrong", "the real question is"
- Use em dashes. Commas, full stops, or restructure.
- Hedge every claim into meaninglessness
- Pitch. One CTA at the end is enough. An article that sells throughout gets read as an ad and cited by nobody.

Spelling: UK English throughout, except brand names, product names and quoted material. Watch for US spellings that slip in around numbers and data: *maths*, not *math*.

Metadata

Field	Rule
Title tag	The question, in search language, under 60 characters
Meta description	140–155 characters. States the answer or the framework, doesn't restate the H1. No HTML entities.
Slug	Target keyword, lowercase, hyphens. Match the search phrase, not the internal one.
OG title / description	Match the title tag and meta. Check for escaped entities.
Category	One of the defined set. Add to the taxonomy deliberately, not ad hoc.
Author	Named person with a role where possible. See below.

Title tag, H1 and meta description must agree on what the article is about. Three different framings across the three fields is a common and avoidable error.

Authors

Named human bylines carry real weight on advisory content, for readers and for AI citation. An article making claims about buyer behaviour and cost per lead is stronger with a person and a role attached.

- **Strategy, measurement and opinion pieces:**
named byline, with an author page carrying role, LinkedIn and areas of expertise
- **Roundups, templates and reference pieces:**
"Credible team" is fine

Author pages need enough substance to support the byline. A name and nothing else is worse than no name.

Technical requirements

Headings

```
H1    one per page, never repeated as an H2
H2    each section
H3    only for genuine sub-sections within
      an H2
```

Anchors

Semantic and hand-set: `#audience-fit`, `#faq`.
Never auto-generated timestamps. Broken or meaningless anchors lose the passage-linking advantage in AI answers.

Dates

`datePublished` and `dateModified`, both visible and both in schema. Update `dateModified` on any substantive revision.

A section where the newest article is months old reads as abandoned, to readers and to crawlers.

Alt text

Every image, describing what it shows.

Schema

`BlogPosting` with `headline`, `datePublished`, `dateModified`, `author`, `publisher`, plus `FAQPage` for the FAQ block.

Pre-publish QA

Argument

- ☐ The position is stated, not implied
- ☐ A competitor couldn't publish this unchanged
- ☐ The strongest counter-argument is acknowledged
- ☐ The reader has something to act on

Search

- ☐ Target keyword has verified volume
- ☐ Title, H1 and meta agree
- ☐ Slug matches the search phrase
- ☐ No overlap with an existing article that would cannibalise

Extraction

- ☐ Opening answers the H1 in 40–60 self-contained words
- ☐ Every H2 opens with its own direct answer
- ☐ H2s read as argument steps, not filing labels
- ☐ FAQ present, 3–5 questions, each answerable alone

Evidence

- ☐ Every statistic sourced, dated and linked

- ☐ Illustrative examples labelled as illustrative
- ☐ Arithmetic in worked examples checked
- ☐ At least one case study linked as evidence

Structure

- ☐ One H1, no duplicate as first H2
- ☐ Semantic anchors
- ☐ Links up to pillar, out to a case study, out to roster, across to a sibling
- ☐ 800 words or more

Technical

- ☐ Meta 140–155 characters, no entities
- ☐ Published and modified dates present
- ☐ Alt text on every image
- ☐ BlogPosting and FAQPage schema validate

Voice

- ☐ No contrast framing
- ☐ No em dashes
- ☐ UK English throughout
- ☐ One CTA, at the end

Template

[Question, in search language]

[Standfirst: one or two sentences stating the position.]

[Opening answer: 40-60 words answering the H1 directly, complete on its own.]

[Context, sourced, linked.]

[Argument step one]

[Direct answer to this section's implicit question.]

[Reasoning. Specifics. Numbers.]

[Link to a case study as evidence.]

[Argument step two]

[Direct answer.]

[Reasoning.]

[The counter-argument, acknowledged]

[Where the opposite is true, and why it doesn't change the conclusion.]

Where to start

[Something actionable.]

[One CTA: browse the roster, or send a brief.]

FAQ

[Real question, as asked]
[40-70 word answer, complete on its own.]

[Real question]
[Answer.]

[Real question]
[Answer.]